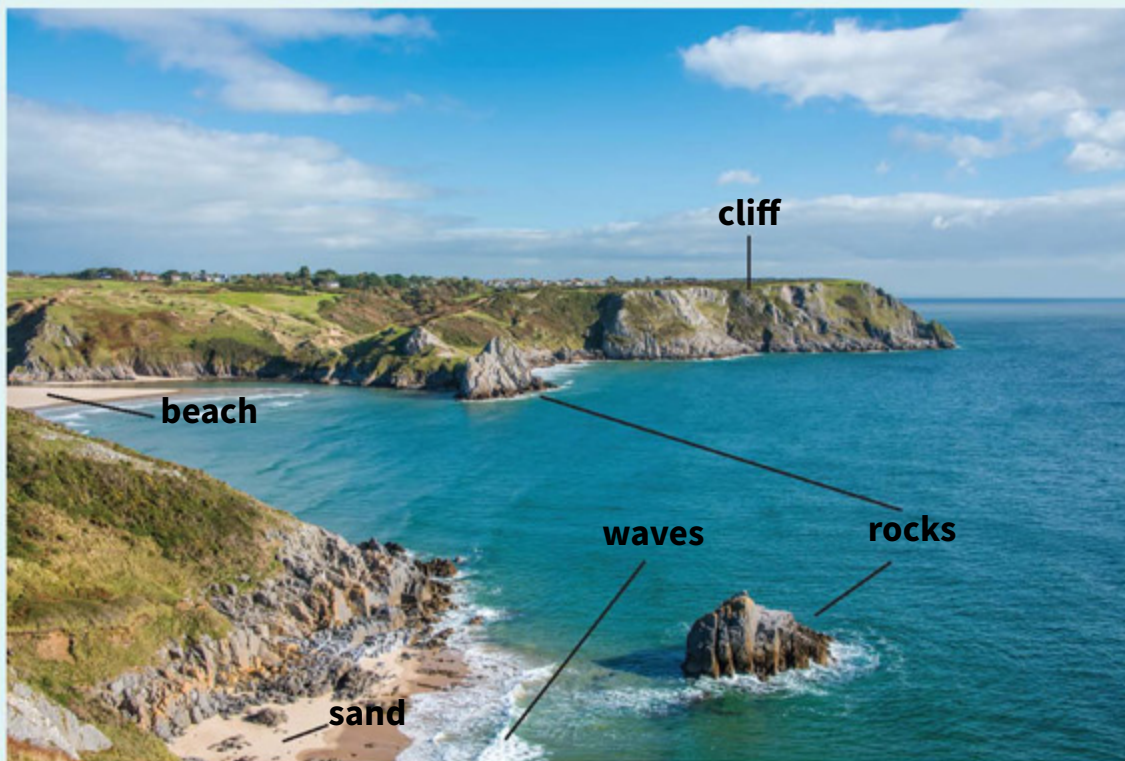


A

The beach



Many people **spend** their holiday at the **coast** [the land close to the sea], where there are a lot of **seaside resorts** [towns by the sea for tourists] and they can go to the beach every day. Generally people prefer beaches that are **sandy** [with lots of sand], where you can go for a **stroll** [a casual walk] along the **shore** [the place where the sea meets the land] in the **sunshine** [when it is sunny]. On the beach, you also sometimes get a **breeze** [a nice gentle wind] that blows off the sea.

B

Beach activities



surfing



windsurfing



diving



playing volleyball



sunbathing

Volleyball is a popular beach game and some people enjoy water sports such as **surfing**, **windsurfing** or **diving**. If the sea is **calm**¹, you can **go for a swim**, but a lot of people just want to lie on the beach and **sunbathe** and get a nice **(sun)tan**². However, there are now worries about the dangers of **sunbathing**. People who lie in the sun without any **protection**³ can get **sunburn**⁴, and worse still, they are **at risk of**⁵ getting skin cancer. Doctors now **recommend**⁶ that people do not sit in the sun without using **sunscreen**⁷. It may be safer just to sit in the **shade**⁸.

¹ without waves (does not move very much); *opp* rough

² when the skin becomes brown

³ something to keep someone safe

⁴ when the skin becomes red and very sore

⁵ if you are at risk of something, there is a danger that something bad may happen to you

⁶ say what someone should do

⁷ cream that gives protection from the sun; *syns* **sunblock, sun cream**

⁸ an area where there is no light from the sun, so it is darker and less hot

Language help

We can **go for a walk**, a **drive** (a journey in the car for pleasure), a **swim**, a **coffee** [drink some coffee], a **drink** (often an alcoholic drink, e.g. wine, beer). We can also **have a swim**, a **coffee**, a **drink**.

We **went for a drive** along the coast. I **had a coffee** at Caffé Nero. Let's **go for a drink** tonight.